

0→1 Startup Club

Fall 2026 Hackathon Builder Packet

Event Overview

Welcome to the Fall 2026 0→1 Hackathon!

Prompt: Explore and build a usable solution for a problem students frequently face.

Prize Pool: \$1,000 for first, \$250 for audience vote.

Announcements: [0→1 Startup Club Slack Channel](#)

Submission Platform: [Fall 2026 0-1 Hackathon Submission](#)

Submit Project

Event Schedule

Stage	Date & Time	Location / Platform	Details
Presentation	Friday, Sept 25 @ 6 PM	HSEC 3-110	Prompt release, sponsor introductions, and rules overview
Building Period Starts	Friday, Sept 25 @ 7 PM	Self Organized	Teams begin building. Work recommendation: The Toast

	Stage	Date & Time	Location / Platform	Details	
	Hours	Saturday, Sept 26 @ 11 - 1 PM	Toaster in Walter Library	Hands-on workshop covering tools, product design, and pitching.	
	Submission	Monday, Sept 28 @ 6:00 PM	Online Submission	Submit prototype link and pitch slides.	
	Day & Final Judging	Tuesday, Sept 29 @ 6 - 8 PM	Keller Hall 3-230	Top 7 selected teams present pitches to judges.	

Instructions & Guidelines

Submission Deliverables

To be eligible for final evaluation and Demo Day, all teams must submit the following before the deadline:

1. **Working Prototype Link:** Hosted project or Lovable application link.
2. **Presentation Deck:** Pitch slides (up to 7 minutes presentation time).

The submission platform can be found above. Only 1 submission per team is allowed. Include all team members' names in submission.

Tooling & Credits

- **Lovable Pro Access:** All attendees receive 1 month of Lovable Pro Plan 1 (\$100 / 100 credits value).
 - **Redemption Code:** COMM-01-CUTS
 - **Instructions:** Go to lovable.dev -> Settings -> Plans & Credits -> Select Pro Plan 1 (Monthly) -> Apply discount code at checkout.
- Use of all AI tools are allowed.
- You are NOT required to host your project on Lovable. Your project must be accessible by link.

Team Requirements

- **Size:** Minimum 2, maximum 5 members per team.
- **Eligibility:** Open to everyone. Prizes can only be awarded to UMN students.

Judging Criteria & Rubric

Demo Day

7 teams will be selected and notified Sept 29 @ 7 AM of their advancement to demo day. At least one team member is required to present to the panel of judges during the given time slot. Any person is allowed to attend and vote for the audience favorite.

During the Demo Day selected teams will:

- Give a 7 minute pitch
- Answer 1-2 questions presented by judges
- Demonstrate their working prototype
- Explain their key design and technical decisions
- Explain their impact and target users
- Address questions about accessibility, privacy, and scalability
- Discuss limitations and future opportunities

Rubric

Category	Max Score	Evaluation Criteria
Impact & Empathy	15 points	Does the team clearly understand the problem and the people affected? Does the solution meaningfully address a real need?
Technical Execution	20 points	Does the prototype work? Does it demonstrate the core functionality effectively? Is technology used meaningfully?
Accessibility	15 points	Can the intended users realistically access and use the solution? Does it consider disability, literacy,

Category	Max Score	Evaluation Criteria
		language, connectivity, devices, and other barriers?
Innovation & Novelty	10 points	Is the approach creative, differentiated, or meaningfully new? Does it challenge conventional approaches to the problem?
Scalability & Feasibility	15 points	Could this realistically be deployed and expanded? Has the team considered resources, infrastructure, adoption, and sustainability?
Total	75 points	

Important Links

- **Community & Announcements:** [0-1 Startup Club Slack Channel](#)
- **Event Registration Page:** [0-1 Luma Event Portal](#)
- **Social Media:** [Instagram \(@0to1umn\)](#)
- **Prototyping Tool:** [Lovable Platform](#)
- **Kickoff Presentation:** [PDF Link](#)

Important Contacts

For questions regarding logistics, schedule flexibility, or technical support, email zeroone@umn.edu or DM 0-1 on slack.

Need Help?

Visit us during office hours in the Toaster!

Slide Deck

Your slide deck is the pitch that really sells your project. Some key points to includes:

- The problem you are addressing
- Your solution
- Why is your solution the best
- Future plans for your solution
- Market feedback
- Demo

For some examples check out <https://bestpitchdeck.com/>.

Lovable

Check out <https://academy.lovable.app/academy>.